

INDUSTRY NEWS

Electronics to drive growth, revenue and employment

The government of India has received proposals worth ₹ 650 billion for electronics manufacturing in the country under modified special incentive package scheme (M-SIPS). Approval has been given to 21 electronics manufacturing clusters worth ₹ 90 billion.

IT industry body Nasscom and India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA) have entered into an agreement to work together with the aim to push the share of electronics manufacturing and information technology (IT) to 25 per cent of the country's GDP by 2025.

India has been a global leader in building and delivering software and IT services, which contributes more than nine per cent of the GDP but its electronics market is almost entirely dominated by imports.

Both organisations would work on identifying key growth areas, facilitate business tieups among members and work with the government for setting up an incubation centre.

India to oppose WTO move to expand ITA products list

India will oppose any expansion of the products list under Information Technology Agreement of World Trade Organisation (WTO), whereby signatories, including India, are committed to the total elimination of customs duties on IT and electronics products.

The Department of Electronics and IT (DeitY) has said that, any such move would hurt the Make in India initiative and discourage investments towards local manufacturing of electronics products. Last year, the country had attracted ₹ 220 billion worth of investment proposals from multinationals.

Certain world powers have been pushing for adding around 256

Kazuo Ninomiya named Nikon India MD

As managing director Hiroshi Takashina moves to take charge of Nikon's Chinese operations, Kazuo Ninomiya takes over as managing director for India.

Rohit Sandal joins Lenovo as India HR head

Chinese computer technology company Lenovo has appointed Rohit Sandal as India HR head. Sandal will be responsible for handling the company's HR strategy and operations in India.

Ashok Lalla quits Infosys

After three years as global head - digital marketing of Infosys, Ashok Lalla has

decided to move on from the company. He will now play digital advisor to brands and agencies.

Kiran Visweswaraiha appointed as new GM of Bharat Electronics

Kiran Visweswaraiha has taken charge as the new general manager - international marketing of Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL).

IBM hires Stephen R. Pratt for billion-dollar Watson project

Former Infosys consulting head Stephen R. Pratt has joined the world's biggest computer services company, International Business Machines (IBM), where he will work on the company's billion-dollar path-breaking Watson project.

products to the list that has not been updated since the treaty was signed in 1997, which, if implemented, will remove tariffs on an additional US\$ 1 trillion global trade, annually.

Currently, 203 ICT products, including laptops, mobile devices, network equipment and set-top boxes are covered under the ITA. About 75 WTO countries, including the USA, China, Japan and all 27 European Union nations, are signatories to it.

Low-cost OLED screens top priority for researchers in India

G. Rajeswaran, leader of the team that developed organic light emitting diodes (OLEDs) in Eastman Kodak, has plans to bring in a disruptive technology to kickstart domestic manufacturing in OLEDs. IIT Madras is partnering him in the endeavour. Rajeswaran and IIT Madras are developing the initial ideas for an R&D project to manufacture OLED screens at a low cost in the country.

If approved and funded by the government, this ₹ 500 million project could develop processes that are required for an entrepreneur to set up

manufacturing facilities at less than ₹ 1 billion.

STPI, IESA to set up Electropreneur Park

Software Technology Parks of India (STPI) has partnered with India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA) to set up an Electropreneur Park, which is aimed at supporting 50 start-ups working on electronics product designing and development over the next five years.

The initiative has a corpus of ₹ 220 million, and will focus on IP creation and product development to increase value addition in domestic manufacturing of electronic items like smartphones, smartmeters, micro ATMs and set-top boxes.

India's solar capacity set to double this year

India is set to double its installed capacity of solar power this year, claims a new forecast done by the Mercom Capital Group. It revealed that more than 2GW of capacity will be installed in 2015, compared to